

Ultrasonic Surgery

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

50.8

Manual Section Title

Ultrasonic Surgery

Version Number

1

Effective Date of this Version

This is a longstanding national coverage determination. The effective date of this version has not been posted.

Description Information

Benefit Category

Physicians' Services

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

Reimbursement may be made for ultrasonic surgery when required in the treatment of patients with severe and recurrent episodes of vertigo due to Meniere's syndrome. This procedure utilizes a machine that produces ultrasonic waves of high intensity and frequency that selectively irradiate certain portions of the inner ear thereby destroying the tissue. The procedure is usually done under local anesthesia, and requires the services of a surgeon and another individual who is responsible for calibrating the electrical equipment, and who assists in observing certain physical changes (e.g., movement of the eyes, "nystagmus") indicative of inner ear reaction to the ultrasonic destruction. Except in rare instances the desired result is achieved with one treatment. At present, there are two different approaches being used to apply the ultrasound to the inner ear: one through the lateral semicircular canal and, more recently, a simpler approach from a technical viewpoint, through the round window.

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Ultrasonic Surgery	1	01/01/1966 - N/A	You are here